

County Administration Workshop: July 28, 2026

1:30 p.m. - Board of Commissioners Conference Room

Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

The Board declared there are no potential conflicts of interest.

2. Department Business

a. Assessor

1. ORMAP Intergovernmental Agreement Contract #PO-15000-00062322

Chris Parton, County Assessor, presented the ORMAP Intergovernmental Agreement Contract and requested authorization to execute the agreement on behalf of Josephine County. The agreement provides State funding for the Assessor's Office to continue digitizing and republishing County tax maps.

Mr. Parton explained that the funding would support approximately 0.80 full-time equivalent personnel for one year. Josephine County maintains nearly 1,200 tax maps, and many maps covering the more remote portions of the County had not been comprehensively updated for more than 20 years. The older maps were originally prepared using manual drafting methods and are now being converted into a modern digital format for use by County staff and the public.

The department had already begun the work and was maintaining a current list of completed and pending maps. Mr. Parton anticipated that the project would require at least one year and noted that the agreement allows the parties to consider an extension if additional time is needed to complete the eligible work.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve ORMAP Intergovernmental Agreement Contract #PO-15000-00062322 and authorize the Assessor to sign the agreement. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

b. Public Works

1. Advisory Board Appointments

Rob Brandes, Public Works Director, presented proposed appointments to three transportation and solid waste committees on which Public Works has historically represented Josephine County.

Mr. Brandes first discussed the Rogue Valley Area Commission on Transportation, commonly referred to as RVACT. The commission includes public- and private-sector representatives from Josephine and Jackson Counties and reviews and prioritizes transportation projects for consideration at the regional and state levels. The proposed arrangement would retain the current Public Works representative as Josephine County's primary voting member and designate Mr. Brandes as the alternate.

The Board next discussed the Josephine County/Grants Pass Solid Waste Agency. The agency includes three County representatives, three City of Grants Pass representatives, and one City of Cave Junction representative. It oversees franchise agreements involving Republic Services and Waste Connections and addresses rates, audits, routes, customer concerns, and solid waste enforcement. Mr. Brandes offered to serve because of his long-term institutional knowledge of the agency and its programs.

The final appointment involved the Middle Rogue Metropolitan Planning Organization Policy Committee. Mr. Brandes explained that the organization includes a Citizens Advisory Committee, Technical Advisory Committee, and Policy Committee. The proposed arrangement would allow the current Public Works representative to concentrate on the Technical Advisory Committee while Mr. Brandes served on the Policy Committee.

Commissioners emphasized that the committees' recommendations and project-prioritization decisions can substantially affect Josephine County. Discussion also addressed the Solid Waste Agency's audit authority and the value of using enforcement and voluntary compliance to reduce illegal dumping rather than attempting to physically remove every instance of improperly discarded material.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the Public Works Advisory Board appointments as presented. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

2. Purchase of four (4) pick-up trucks, Operation Division Replacements

Mr. Brandes requested authorization to purchase four replacement pickup trucks for the Public Works Operations Division. Two of the vehicles scheduled for replacement had approximately 170,000 and 190,000 miles. Other vehicles had developed computer and electrical-control problems affecting air conditioning, exhaust systems, battery performance, and general reliability.

The replacement trucks would support daily operations, including transporting crews and materials, pilot-car duties, emergency response, and snow-plowing activities. The vehicles would be purchased through the State cooperative purchasing contract at an estimated cost of approximately \$47,000 each, compared with a manufacturer's suggested retail price of approximately \$56,000. Public Works would also install bed liners, headache racks, and quick-response snowplow attachments where appropriate.

Three of the vehicles being replaced were 2009 models, and one was a 1998 model. Commissioners discussed the County Fleet Program's effort to replace vehicles while they retain resale value. Mr. Brandes explained that Public Works generally retains heavy-duty vehicles longer than passenger vehicles because they are designed for extended use and the department can temporarily reassign vehicles when a unit is unavailable.

Public Works vehicles also experience considerable idling, low-speed operation, and worksite use that may not be reflected by mileage alone. Before the replaced vehicles are offered at public auction, they will be evaluated for possible reassignment to other County departments.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve the purchase of four (4) pick-up trucks as Operation Division replacements.

Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

3. Amendment 2 ODOT Delivered Federal Project Wolf Creek Bridge

Mr. Brandes presented Amendment 2 to the Oregon Department of Transportation agreement for replacement of a weight-restricted bridge in the Wolf Creek area. The bridge provides access between the Lower Wolf Creek and Grave Creek areas and is limited to approximately 15 tons under its most restrictive vehicle configuration.

The existing alignment also creates difficulty for longer commercial vehicles because the bridge connects to the roadway near a steep embankment and at an unfavorable angle. The replacement project would shift the bridge alignment to provide a safer approach and improve access for commercial, emergency, and logging vehicles.

The estimated project cost had increased by approximately \$400,000 as engineering and design work progressed. ODOT would provide approximately \$111,000 of the additional amount, and Public Works would be responsible for approximately \$284,000. Mr. Brandes noted that the County's ordinary match for eligible bridge projects is approximately 10.27 percent, although the County's share of this amendment was greater.

Construction was anticipated to begin in approximately May 2027 and continue for three to four months. The bridge would be closed during construction because the traffic volume did not support the cost of a temporary bridge. Depending upon a traveler's location, the detour could add approximately nine to 35 minutes.

Mr. Brandes explained that the County applies for every practical State and federal bridge opportunity because the available funding allows Josephine County to replace major infrastructure at a fraction of the total cost. The County obtained funding for three bridges during the applicable funding cycle.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Amendment 2 for the ODOT Delivered Federal Project, Wolf Creek Bridge, as amended. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes;

Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

c. Transit

1. Designation of Signature Authority

Scott Chancey, Transit Manager, requested that the Finance Director be designated as an authorized official for Federal Transit Administration grant submissions and National Transit Database reporting.

Mr. Chancey explained that the designation provides an appropriate separation of duties. Transit staff prepare grant applications and compile the required ridership, financial, cost-per-mile, and operational information. The Finance Director would formally submit or certify the completed information so that the same individual would not prepare, submit, and approve a grant or federal report.

The designation would not eliminate the Board's authority or any required legal review. It would establish the Finance Director as the County's authorized official for the applicable federal reporting and submission systems, consistent with the arrangement historically used by the Transit program.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve the designation of signature authority as presented. Commissioner Smith seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

2. DHS - IGA 188044

Mr. Chancey presented Oregon Department of Human Services Intergovernmental Agreement No. 188044 involving transportation for eligible elderly and disabled individuals receiving qualifying home-support services.

Transit currently provides door-to-door service within three-quarters of a mile of its fixed routes. Eligible passengers generally pay approximately \$2 per trip. Under the proposed agreement, the County could request reimbursement for the marginal cost of qualifying rides, estimated at approximately \$41.97 per trip.

The program would not require Transit to extend service beyond its existing service area, operating hours, or holiday schedule. Mr. Chancey stated that technological improvements would make the program easier to administer than a similar program used approximately six or seven years earlier.

The number of eligible local clients had not yet been confirmed, although Mr. Chancey anticipated fewer than 50. Transit had the capacity to provide approximately 100 additional rides per month without adding staff or vehicles. Approximately \$45,000 in anticipated revenue had been included in the department's budget, although the actual amount would depend upon participation.

Legal Counsel had reviewed the agreement. Reimbursement would be requested after qualifying trips were provided and documented. The Board agreed that receiving the federal reimbursement would more accurately recognize the cost of providing the service than collecting only the ordinary passenger fare.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve DHS Intergovernmental Agreement No. 188044 and authorize the Chair to sign. Commissioner Smith seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

d. Airports

1. Airports Department Update

Mike Crisafulli, Airports Manager, provided an update regarding capital projects and operations at the Grants Pass and Illinois Valley Airports.

Taxiway Alpha Extension

The FAA grant agreement and construction contract for the Taxiway Alpha Extension had been received. Knife River Materials would require approximately one to one-and-one-half months to complete required submittals, testing, mobilization, and other preconstruction work. Construction was expected to begin near the end of August and the contract provided a 50-day construction period.

The contract amount was approximately \$1.694 million, compared with an engineer's estimate of approximately \$2.29 million and a next-lowest bid of approximately \$2.8 million. Staff would monitor weather and smoke conditions because rain or wildfire smoke could affect construction and striping operations.

Illinois Valley Airport Fuel Farm

All Construction Elements, a Cave Junction contractor, was completing the Illinois Valley Airport fuel farm project. The approximately \$566,000 project was funded through a State grant awarded under House Bill 5202. The principal delay involved fabrication and delivery of the fuel tank, which required approximately four months after approval of the contractor's submittals. Delivery was anticipated in October or November, with the remaining work coordinated so the facility could be operational before the following spring.

Runway 13/31 Extension and Hangar Building

The Runway 13/31 Extension was in the closeout phase. The FAA was scheduling a flight inspection, with an additional inspection anticipated later in the summer for the instrument approaches. Staff expected the first inspection to occur within approximately four weeks. Construction of the four-unit hangar building was complete, and the County was waiting for the contractor's final invoice before closing the project.

Wildfire Operations

The airports had experienced less wildfire-related aircraft activity than during the prior year because some response aircraft were staged closer to current incidents. During the prior September, approximately 13 helicopters had been staged at the airport. Airports was using asphalt grindings from a Knife River highway project to construct temporary helicopter parking pads in previously unusable areas, providing additional stabilized parking capacity during future wildfire operations.

Hangar Leases and Insurance Requirements

There were no current hangar vacancies. Staff continued working through expired or incomplete ground leases and had substantially completed a commercial ground-lease template. A private-hangar ground-lease template was expected to require additional time.

Mr. Crisafulli was also working with the County's insurance representatives to review and standardize insurance requirements. Private hangar tenants had reported annual insurance quotes of approximately \$1,500 for policies meeting a

\$1 million requirement, which in some cases exceeded the annual ground rent. Staff would evaluate the County's actual liability exposure and existing airport coverage before recommending an appropriate requirement.

Most airport tenants were current on rent. Staff identified a limited number of past-due accounts and was pursuing payment under the applicable lease terms. Airports was also evaluating online and recurring-payment options through its lease-management software.

No formal action was taken on the department update.

2. FAA Grant Agreement No. 3S8-NMG-3-41-023-021-2026

Mr. Crisafulli presented FAA Grant Agreement No. 3S8-NMG-3-41-023-021-2026 supporting the Taxiway Alpha Extension and remaining eligible costs associated with the Runway 13/31 Extension.

The grant amount was approximately \$2,759,417 toward a total eligible project cost of approximately \$2.904 million. The difference represented the required local share. The Oregon Department of Aviation would provide approximately 91 percent of that local share, leaving Josephine County responsible for approximately \$15,000.

The FAA funding is reimbursement-based. The County must complete the eligible work, pay the associated costs, and submit documentation before receiving reimbursement. Legal Counsel had reviewed and approved the agreement as to form.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve FAA Grant Agreement No. 3S8-NMG-3-41-023-021-2026 and authorize Mr. Crisafulli to sign. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

3. Contract: LTM, Inc. dba Knife River Materials amount \$1,694,008.00

Mr. Crisafulli presented the construction contract with LTM, Inc., doing business as Knife River Materials, in the amount of \$1,694,008.00 for the Taxiway Alpha Extension.

Knife River submitted the lowest responsive bid. The next-lowest bid was approximately \$2.8 million. Knife River had already executed the contract and was prepared to begin completing the required preconstruction submittals and testing.

The contract established a 50-day construction period beginning on the notice-to-proceed date and provided for liquidated damages of \$1,000 per day if the contractor exceeded the contractual completion period. Eligible project costs would be reimbursed from the FAA grant as work was completed and documented.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve the contract with LTM, Inc. dba Knife River Materials in the amount of \$1,694,008.00 and authorize Mr. Crisafulli to sign. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

e. Community Justice

1. Josephine County Provider Contract with ADAPT for Outpatient Treatment Services \$113,000.00

Scott Hyde, Community Justice Director, presented a provider contract with ADAPT for outpatient substance-use-disorder treatment services.

Mr. Hyde explained that the contract was funded through Oregon Health Authority Intergovernmental Agreement No. 54291, previously approved by the Board. The larger agreement provides approximately \$8.31 million for behavioral-health services in Josephine County, with most funds allocated to Options for Southern Oregon for mental-health treatment and a portion allocated to outpatient substance-use-disorder providers.

The ADAPT contract would run from January 1, 2026, through June 30, 2027, unless the underlying agreement was amended, extended, or terminated. The maximum amount payable under the contract was \$113,000.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the Josephine County Provider Contract with ADAPT for Outpatient Treatment Services in the amount of \$113,000.00 and authorize Shawn Martinez to sign. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

2. Josephine County Provider Contract with Options for Southern Oregon, DBA Choices Counseling Center for Outpatient Treatment Services \$75,000.00

Mr. Hyde presented a second outpatient substance-use-disorder treatment contract funded through the Oregon Health Authority agreement. The provider was Options for Southern Oregon, doing business as Choices Counseling Center.

The contract would run from January 1, 2026, through June 30, 2027, unless the underlying agreement was amended, extended, or terminated. The maximum amount payable under the contract was \$75,000.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the Josephine County Provider Contract with Options for Southern Oregon, dba Choices Counseling Center, for Outpatient Treatment Services in the amount of \$75,000.00 and authorize Shawn

Martinez to sign. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

Commissioner Martin requested that Community Justice provide future reports describing the number and type of treatment services delivered, program participation, expenditures, and measurable outcomes. Mr. Hyde explained that the providers submit data semiannually and that Treatment Manager Shawn Martinez tracks and reports the required information to the Oregon Health Authority. He agreed to include the results in the department's regular reports to the Board.

f. Human Resources

1. Position Requisition

- a)** Facilities - Custodian - Add position - Approved in the 2026-2027 Budget
- b)** Juvenile - Food Service Specialist 1 - Re-fill vacant position, vacating July 31
- c)** District Attorney - Medicolegal Death investigator - Add part time position - Approved in the 2026-2027 Budget

Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director, presented three position requisitions. The Facilities Custodian and part-time District Attorney Medicolegal Death Investigator positions had been approved through the Fiscal Year 2026-2027 budget. The Juvenile Justice Food Service Specialist I request would refill a position becoming vacant on July 31, 2026.

Ryan Johnson, Facilities Director, explained that Facilities already had a custodial vacancy and two employees on leave. One employee was therefore primarily responsible for cleaning the Courthouse and Justice Building, with limited assistance during later shifts. Filling the approved custodian position was necessary to maintain service and reduce the risk of further staff burnout.

The Juvenile Justice Food Service Specialist assists with preparation of breakfast, lunch, and dinner for youth in detention and residential programs. Without the part-time position, one full-time employee would be responsible for covering meal service seven days per week.

The part-time Medicolegal Death Investigator would work under the lead investigator in the District Attorney's Office. Human Resources provided the Board with both job descriptions so the Commissioners could review the distinctions in duties, responsibility, and compensation.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the Human Resources position requisitions as presented. Commissioner Smith seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

2. Invoices

- a)** SAIF Invoice in the amount of \$406,616.39

Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe presented the County's annual SAIF workers' compensation insurance invoice in the amount of \$406,616.39. The coverage became effective July 1, 2026. The Board had previously authorized execution of the renewal documents, and the present request was for payment of the resulting invoice.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve payment of the SAIF invoice in the amount of \$406,616.39. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

3. Other Matters

- a)** Non-Union Insurance Contribution Amounts

Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe requested that the Board establish the County's medical-insurance contribution increase for non-union employees before open enrollment began on August 15, 2026.

The Personnel Policy Manual generally directs the County to increase the contribution using the applicable June-to-June medical Consumer Price Index while allowing the Board to select an alternative rate. Human Resources identified an error in the policy language that would require correction.

The applicable increase for AFSCME and the Sergeants Association was 3.3 percent. The increase for LiUNA employees was 3 percent because its agreement used a different regional index. Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe recommended providing an increase to non-union employees because most represented employees were receiving an adjustment and many non-union employees held confidential or supervisory positions.

Discussion addressed maintaining appropriate compensation differences between union and non-union positions and avoiding wage-and-benefit compression. Commissioner Martin supported the 3.3 percent rate identified in the Personnel Policy Manual, while Commissioner Richardson favored a 3 percent increase.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve the non-union insurance contribution amount at 3 percent. Commissioner Smith seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

3. Board Business

a. Communications

The Board continued its discussion regarding replacement of the County's public safety radio communications system. Ryan Johnson, Facilities Director, reported that Federal Engineering had provided a draft assessment. He had requested several revisions and anticipated receiving an updated report before the end of the week.

Commissioner Martin discussed the need for a Board resolution formally identifying the communications project as a County priority. Such a resolution could support federal appropriations and grant requests and demonstrate that the project was being actively developed. She had requested that Legal Counsel prepare the resolution.

The Board also discussed the need for Day Wireless and Motorola to provide a complete proposed project scope. Commissioners wanted sufficient information to develop a shovel-ready project before approaching federal and State representatives for assistance. Although Day Wireless had been given approximately two weeks to prepare additional information, the Board requested that staff seek preliminary material sooner so Commissioners would have time to review it.

Commissioner Martin reported that an Illinois Valley and Oregon State University graduate currently working with a Motorola radio system for the City of Portland had offered to share technical experience and lessons learned. The Board welcomed additional information from members of the public with expertise in telecommunications or emergency radio systems.

No formal action was taken.

b. Law Enforcement Service District Citizens Advisory Committee Application - Cheryl Johnson

The Board considered Cheryl Johnson's application for appointment to the Law Enforcement Service District Citizens Advisory Committee.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve the application of Cheryl Johnson to serve on the Law Enforcement Service District Citizens Advisory Committee. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

Chair Ron Smith called for Executive Session at 2:46 p.m. The detailed Executive Session minutes are included below as a confidential portion of this record.

Additional Attendees: Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director; Scott Hyde, Community Justice Director; Matt Eide, Finance Director; and Chris Bristol, Daily Courier.

4. Executive Session

- a. To conduct deliberations with persons designated to carry on labor negotiations. ORS 192.660(2)(d).
- b. To consider the employment of a public officer, employee, staff member, or individual agent. ORS 192.660(2)(a).

Executive Session concluded at 3:47 p.m.

5. Open Session of the Admin Workshop

The Board reconvened in Open Session at 3:47 p.m. Commissioner Martin summarized the direction provided during Executive Session.

- a. To conduct deliberations with persons designated to carry on labor negotiations.

Commissioner Martin moved to authorize the Human Resources Department to proceed as directed regarding labor negotiations. Commissioner Smith seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

- b. To consider the employment of a public officer, employee, staff member, or individual agent.

Commissioner Martin moved to authorize the Human Resources Department to process position requisitions for one Board Office Administrator and one Board Administrative Secretary as directed. Commissioner Smith seconded the

motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

Commissioner Martin moved to authorize the Human Resources Department to proceed with the hiring processes for the Human Resources Department as directed. Commissioner Smith seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

6. Other

None

7. Additional Subject Matters from Commissioners/Announcements

Commissioners encouraged the public to attend the Josephine County Fair and reminded attendees to remain cautious with matches and other ignition sources during fire season.

The meeting adjourned at 3:48 p.m.